The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called the Heart of Amoghapāśa

Āryāmoghapāśahṛdayanāmamahāyānasūtra · Toh 901 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་དབྱེ་ཡངྟ་ཞགས་པའ་སིདྡི་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱ་ཐེག་པ་ཆནེ་པའོ་མདོ།

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called the Heart of Amoghapāśa, known in Sanskrit as the Āryāmoghapāśahṛdayanāmamahāyānasūtra and in Tibetan as Phakpa Dönyö Zhakpé Nyingpo, is a Mahāyāna scripture centered on Amoghapāśa, the form of the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara whose name means "Unfailing Lasso," symbolizing his ability to draw beings to liberation. The discourse is set on the summit of Mount Potalaka, Avalokiteśvara's jeweled and tree-adorned abode, where the Buddha teaches before a vast assembly of monks, bodhisattvas, and young gods of the Pure Abodes, including Īśvara and Maheśvara. In this setting Avalokiteśvara presents the heart mantra of Amoghapāśa together with an account of its benefits and the practices for its use. The work is Toh 901 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the collection of scriptures devoted to protective and liberating spells, and it is closely related to the tantric literature surrounding Amoghapāśa.

In Sanskrit: āryāmoghapāśahṛdayaṃnāmamahāyānasūtra
In Tibetan: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called the Heart of Amoghapāśa.

Homage to noble Amoghapāśa!
Homage to the Buddha!
Homage to the Greatly Compassionate One!

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling on the summit of Mount Potalaka, the abode of noble Avalokiteśvara. It was beautifully adorned with many trees, such as sāla, tamāla, campaka, aśoka and atimuktaka, and with trees of all kinds of jewels. He was dwelling there together with a great Saṅgha of eighteen thousand monks, ninety-nine hundred thousand koṭi-niyutas of bodhisattvas, and many thousands of young gods of the Pure Abodes, who surrounded him and placed him at their head. He was teaching the Dharma, chiefly to the young gods Īśvara, Maheśvara (Śiva), and those of the Brahmakāyika realm.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being, noble Avalokiteśvara, rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, and set his right knee upon the ground. Joining his palms toward the Blessed One, he bowed, and with a

smiling face he addressed the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, I have what is called the Heart of Amoghapāśa. Ninety-one eons ago, in the world system called Beholding the World, I received it from the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly awakened Buddha Lokendrarāja. And where I received it, many hundreds of thousands of young gods of the Pure Abodes, led by Īśvara and Maheśvara, also gathered. I attained ten hundred thousand samādhis, chief among them the samādhi of the wisdom of Amoghapāśa of unsurpassed, perfect awakening.

"Moreover, Blessed One, it should be understood from the time it is practiced in some area of ground: Blessed One, at that time twelve thousand young gods, led by Īśvara, Maheśvara and the Brahmakāyikas, will dwell in that area in order to protect, guard and shelter it. Blessed One, wherever the Heart of Amoghapāśa is practiced, that area becomes a shrine. Those beings who listen to the Heart of Amoghapāśa will have made offerings to many hundred thousand koṭi-niyutas of buddhas. Blessed One, any bodhisattva who hears the Heart of Amoghapāśa here will generate his own roots of virtue.

"Blessed One, someone may commit the faults of evil, be wholly engaged in every evil deed, slander the noble ones, revile the true Dharma, be headed for the Avīci hell, and revile all the buddhas and bodhisattvas, the noble śrāvakas and the pratyekabuddhas. Yet if he comes to feel remorse and from then on cuts himself off and restrains himself, then, Blessed One, if he recites it while observing even a single day of fasting, the karma of this life of his will be completely purified and completely exhausted. It will be turned back.

"Through a fever of one day, or of two days, of three days, or of four days, or further, through bloody dysentery, or burning fever, or pain in the hands, pain in the feet, or pain in the head, or affliction by hālāhala poison, or leprosy, or swelling of the legs, or a fine rash, or ulcers, or tumors, or small boils, or scabies, or sores bursting on the private parts, or pustules, or disorders that cause forgetfulness, or pain throughout the body, or through being killed, or bound, or beaten, or threatened, or spoken to harshly, in short, Blessed One, through illness of the body, or suffering of the mind, or through seeing bad dreams, his karma will be completely purified and exhausted.

"Beings who were already pure, who have faith and strong devotion, will become utterly and thoroughly purified.

"Blessed One, however much the four assemblies and the four castes may worship me with deceit and guile, those here who listen to the Heart of

Amoghapāśa, who grasp its meaning, who keep it, read it, inquire about it, cause others to inquire about it, master it, cause other beings to listen to it, or who even recite it, pressing close to the ear of one born in the animal realm, and who contemplate these mantra words, should recollect the Buddha by means of this practice: without discarding, without form, without conceptualization, without arising, without long-enduring arising, without deceit, without attachment, with an even mind free of distraction, free of the five aggregates. To them a hundred thousand buddhas of the ten directions will show their faces. Through your recitation, evil deeds will be confessed. However many copies are written in volumes, one should invite them to reside in one's house.

"Blessed One, what need is there for more? Those who listen out of rivalry with one another, or out of fear of their lord, or by following others, or for the sake of disparaging others: the wise should know that this is through the blessing of noble Avalokiteśvara. Its sound will resound in their ears.

"Blessed One, it is like this: suppose some person grinds sandalwood, or camphor, or saffron, or musk, crushing and pounding it on a stone or on the ground, and anoints himself with it. Then the scent of that sandalwood, camphor, saffron or musk is not altered by its being ground or crushed. Its sweet fragrance, too, remains just the same.

"In just the same way, Blessed One, even if someone scorns and reviles this Heart of Amoghapāśa of mine, and, as before, however many worship me with deceit and guile, Blessed One, it will generate roots of virtue for those obstinate beings. Those who take it up with difficulty out of desire are spoken of thus, and so too in later lives. Wherever they are born, there they will never be parted from the fragrance of the accumulations of moral discipline, samādhi, wisdom and merit. It makes them sweetly fragrant with the scent of moral discipline.

"Blessed One, whatever son of good family or daughter of good family, monk or nun, layman or laywoman, or anyone else, devotes himself to the Heart of Amoghapāśa, observes the fast on the eighth day of the bright fortnight, and recites the Heart of Amoghapāśa seven times without speaking aloud, Blessed One, that person should expect twenty benefits, each in turn, in this very life.

"What are the twenty? No illness will arise in his body, and illness that has arisen through the power of karma will quickly subside. His body will become smooth, pleasing, and fair. He will become pleasing to many people. His

senses will be guarded, and he will also obtain wealth. The wealth he has cannot be carried off by thieves. It will not be burned by fire. It will not be swept away by water. It cannot be seized even at the king's whim. His livelihood will prosper. No danger from water will befall his body. No danger from wind and rain will arise. If he recites the Heart of Amoghapāśa seven times over water or ashes and with it makes a binding of the ground in the cardinal and intermediate directions, above and below, all harms will be pacified. Vitality-eaters (ojohāras) cannot steal his vitality. All beings will be pleased with him. Danger that has arisen from enemies will quickly subside. He will not be endangered by fire. No danger of epidemic disease and no danger from ḍākinīs will arise. Even fierce afflictions will not arise. He will not die by fire, water, or weapons. The gods, too, will constantly guard him, protect him, and shelter him. Wherever he is born, there he will never be parted from loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity. These twenty benefits should be expected, each in turn.

"Furthermore, he will obtain eight things, each in turn. What are the eight? At the time of death, the noble Avalokiteśvara will truly show him his face in the form of a monk. He will die peacefully. His vision will be free of confusion. There will be no flailing of the hands. There will be no defecation. There will be no urination. There will be no signs of disturbed winds. He will remain perfectly composed and endowed with mindfulness. He will not die lying face down. At the time of death he will speak free of affliction. He will be born in whatever buddha field he has made an aspiration for. He will never be parted from the spiritual friend.

"It should be recited three times at each of the three periods of every day. Those who especially wish to keep it should abstain from alcohol, meat, onions, garlic, and the leftovers of offerings made to Śaṅkara (Śiva). One should let beings hear this Dharma discourse called the Heart of Amoghapāśa only after ascertaining whether or not they are capable of it. The master should not be miserly, because one who has abandoned the stains of jealousy and miserliness is a bodhisattva. Because he attains the awakening of a buddha for the sake of beings, he also becomes one of the Saṅgha of bodhisattvas. Wisdom is called bodhi, and sattva is skillful means; through these two together the very welfare of beings is achieved. Blessed One, if I repeat this Dharma and recite this heart before the Tathāgata, it is for the benefit and happiness of the four assemblies, and also for the sake of others who commit evil."

Then the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva mahāsattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, "What you have taught to pure beings is timely, and the Tathāgata too rejoices in it. In the latter time, in the latter age, you will perform the role of a father to bodhisattvas."

Then the bodhisattva mahāsattva, the noble Avalokiteśvara, gazing with unblinking eyes, said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, listen! This maṇḍala of liberation, to which all the buddhas and bodhisattvas have paid homage, is for the benefit of many people, for the happiness of many people, out of loving compassion for the world, for the benefit and happiness of the great multitude of beings, and also for the sake of liberation.

namastraiyadhvānugatapratiṣṭhitebhyaḥ sarvabuddhabodhisatvebhyaḥ namaḥ pratyekabuddhāryaśrāvakasaṃghebhyo 'tītānāgatapratyutpannebhyaḥ namaḥ saṃmyakgatānāṃ namaḥ saṃmyakpratyutpannānāṃ namaḥ śāradvatīputrāya mahāmataye nama āryamaitreyapramukhebhyo mahābodhisatvasaṃghebhyaḥ namaḥ supratiṣṭhitaśilendrarājapramukhebhyaḥ sarvatathāgatebhyo 'rhadbhyaḥ saṃmyaksaṃbuddhebhyo bhagavadbhyaḥ

namaḥ suvarṇṇavarṇṇasupratibhāsavinarditeśvararājāya tathāgatāya namaḥ siṃhavikrīḍitarājāya tathāgatāya namaḥ amitābhāya tathāgatāya namaḥ supratiṣthite maṇikūṭarājāya tathāgatāya namaḥ smantarasmyutgataśrīkūṭarājāya tathāgatāya namo vibaśyine tathāgatāya namaḥ śikhine tathāgatāya namo viśvabhuje tathāgatāya namaḥ krakucchānadāya tathāgatāya namaḥ knakamunaye tathāgatāya namaḥ kāśyapāya tathāgatāya namaḥ śākyamunaye tathāgatāyārhate saṃmyaksaṃbuddhaya

tadyathā oṃ mune mune mahāmunaye svāhā oṃ śame śame mahāśame rakṣa rakṣa maṃ sarvasatvāṃśca sarvapāpaṃ praśamane svāhā

namaḥ suparikīrtitanāmadheyāya śriye tathāgatāya namaḥ smantravabhāsavijitasaṃgrāmaśriye tathāgatāya namaḥ indraketudhvajaśriye tathāgatāya namo ratnaprabhāseśvararājāya tathāgatāya namo 'pratihatabhaiṣajyarājāya tathāgatāya namo vikrāntagāmine tathāgatāya namo buddhāya namo dharmāya namaḥ saṃghāya namo 'tītānāgatapratyutpannebho buddhebhyo bhagavadbhyaḥ

tadyathā smṛtivardhani mativardhani gativardhani dhṛtivardhani prajñāvardhani pratibhānavardhani dhyānavardhani śāmasthāvardhani pipaśyanavardhani sarvabodhipakṣadharmavardhani sakalabuddhadharmaparipūraṇeya svāhā

namo ratnatrayāya namo āryāvalokiteśvarāya bodhisatvāya mahāsatvāya mahākāruṇikāya namo mahāsthāmabrāptāya bodhisatvāya mahāsatvāya mahākāruṇikāya ebhyo namskritvā idamāryāvalokiteśvaramukhotgirṇṇa amoghapāśarājanāmahridayaṃ tathāgatāsaṃmukhaṃ bhuṣitaṃ mahatāṃ parṣanmadhye ahamidānīmāvartayiṣyāmi siddhyantu me mantrapadāḥ sarvakāryāṇi sarvabhayebhyo mama sarvasatvānāñca rakṣa bhavatu

tadyathā oṃ cara cara ciri ciri curu curu mara mara miri miri muru muru mahākāruṇika sara sara siri siri suru suru curu curu ciri ciri biri biri piri piri miri miri mahāpadmahasta kala kala kili kili kulu kulu svāhā mahāśuddhasatvāya svāhā budhya budhya bodha bodha bodhi bodhi bodhaya bodhaya kaṇa kaṇa kiṇi kiṇi kuṇu kuṇu paramaśuddhasatva kara kara kiri kiri kuru kuru mahāsthamaprapta cala cala sañcala sañcala vicala vicala pracala pracala eṭaṭa eṭaṭa bhara bhara bhiri bhiri bhuru bhuru tara tara tiri tiri turu turu ehyehi mahākāruṇikā mahāpaśupativeṣadhara dhara dhara dhiri dhiri dhuru dhuru tara tara sara sara cara cara para para vara vara mara mara lara lara hara hara hā hā hī hī hū hū

oṃkāraprahmaveṣadhara dhara dhara dhiri dhiri dhuru dhuru tara tara sara sara cara cara nara nara vara vara hara hara rasmiśatasahasrapratimaṇḍitaśarīra jvala jvala tapa tapa bhāṣa bhāṣa bhrama bhrama bhagavānsauma āditya yama varuṇa kubera prahmandra vāyu agni dhanadā deva ṛṣigaṇābhyarccitacaraṇa suru suru curu curu muru muru ghuru ghuru sanatkumāra rudra vāsava viṣṇu dhanadā vāyu agniṛśi nāyaka vināyakapahuvividhaveṣadhara

oṃ dhara dhara dhiri dhiri dhuru dhuru tara tara thara thara ghara ghara yara yara lara lara hara hara para para sara sara vara vara varadāyaka samanta avalokita vilokita lokiśvara maheśvara tribhuvaneśvara sarvaguṇasamālaṃkṛta avalokiteśvara muhu muhu muru muru muya muya muñca muñca rakṣa rakṣa māṃ sarvasatvāṃśca sarvabhayebhyaḥ sarvopadravebhyaḥ sarvovasargebhyaḥ sarvograhebhyaḥ sarvavyādhibhyaḥ sarvapiṣebhyaḥ sarvajvarabhyaḥ evaṃ baṃdhabandhana tāḍana tarjana rāja taskara agni udaka viṣa śastraparimocaka

kaṇa kaṇa kiṇi kiṇi kuṇu kuṇu cara cara ciri ciri curu curu indrima bala bodhyaṃga caturāryasatyasaṃprakāśaka tapa tapa tama tama dama dama śama śama masa masa dhama dhama mahākāruṇika mahāhamo 'ndhakāravidhaman ṣaṭpāramitāparipūraka mala mala mili mili mulu mulu ṭa ṭa ṭa ṭa ṭha ṭha ṭha ṭha ṭi ṭi ṭi ṭi ṭu ṭu ṭu ṭu ṭhi ṭhi ṭhi ṭhi ṭhu ṭhu ṭhu ṭhu eneyacarmmakṛtaparikara ehyehi mahākāruṇika īśvara maheśvara mahābhūtagaṇasaṃbhañjaka

kara kara kiri kiri kuru kuru para para hara hara vara vara sara sara mara mara kara kara kaṭa kaṭa kiṭi kiṭi kuṭu kuṭu maṭa maṭa mahāviśuddhaviṣayanivāsita mahākāruṇikaśveteyajñopavīṭa ratnamukuṭa mālādhara sarvajñaśirasikṛtajaṭāmukuṭa mahāaddhuta kamalaalaṃkṛtakaratala dhyāna samādhi vimokṣāprakambya bahusatvasantatiparipācaka mahākāruṇikasarvakarmāvaraṇaviśodhaka sarvajñajñānaparibūraka sarvavyādhiparimocaka sarvasatvaāśāparipūraka

sarva satvasamāśvāsanakara namaḥstute svāhā amoghāya svāhā amoghapāśāya svāhā ajitāya svāhā aparājitāya svāhā amitābhāya svāhā imitābhāsutāya svāhā mārasaineyapramardanāya svāhā abhayāya svāhā abhayapradāya svāhā jayāya svāhā vijayāya svāhā jayavijayāya svāhā varadāya svāhā varapradāya svāhā akālamrityupraśamanāya svāhā idañca me karma kuru namaḥstute svāhā oṃ raṇa raṇa hūṃ phaṭ svāhā oṃ jaye hūṃ phaṭ svāhā oṃ jra jriṃ juṃ svāhā oṃ hūṃ jaya svāhā oṃ hrīḥ trailokyavijaya amoghapāśa apratihata hrīḥ haḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā oṃ pasupati svāhā oṃ ārolika svāhā oṃ bahule bahule svāhā oṃ ārolika hrīḥ hrīḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā niyatāniyatavedanīyāśubhasya me bhagavāna karmaṇo'śeṣatāḥ kṣayaṃ kuru svāhā oṃ padmahastāya svāhā aṃ buddhadharmasaṃghāya svāhā

By reciting it, all activities are accomplished. If one recites it at the three times of day, the five acts of immediate retribution are purified, and all karmic obscurations are purified.

The boundary is sealed with agaru incense, ash, water, white mustard seed, pegs of khadira wood, and the like. For all epidemic diseases one should tie a protection cord. For all illnesses one should recite over butter, dark butter, or water, and give it to the sick person. For an illness spread through the body, one should make cutting motions with a weapon and also tie a protection cord. For a stomach ache, one should relieve it with salt water, or else with clay or with water. For an eye disease one should tie a white thread to the ear. For a toothache, use a tooth-stick of karavīra.

To seal the boundary, recite up to twenty-one times over a thread of five colors, tie it to four khadira pegs, and drive them in at the four directions; then the boundary has been sealed. In every case it may be done with a protection cord, with water, or with ash. For all planetary afflictions it is done with a thread of five colors. For all epidemics it is done with a white thread. For snakes, insects, rats, abscesses, and blockage of the throat, it is done with honey mixed with long pepper. For an eye disease it is done with fragrant water, lac water, honey, or licorice. In all times of strife, against quarrels and slander, one should recite over water and wash the face.

Against harm from the king of another land, set full vases around the realm; then a pure person wearing clean clothes should make a great offering and recite, and there will be great peace. If one also sprinkles their water, all beings are protected, and all harms and plagues are pacified.

If one recites up to twenty-one times over a mark of sandalwood used as a seal, it exhausts all acts of immediate retribution. If one recites constantly, it protects the household. A fire offering of lotuses protects all beings. A fire offering of sandalwood protects against all planets, bhūtas, and lunar mansions.

Jayā, vijayā, aparājitā, nākulī, fragrant nākulī, dharaṇī, abhayahastā, indrahastā, fragrant priyaṅgu, tagara, cakra, mahācakra, vimardanā, somarājī, and sunatta: over any one of these one should recite up to one hundred and eight times, make it into a kind of jewel, and tie it on the head and the upper arm. For children, it is tied at the neck. If women wear it at the private parts, they make themselves supremely fortunate; misfortune is removed, and it even grants a son. By wearing this jewel, protection is made everywhere. One cannot be harmed by poison or fire. Even what has been done by poison will not take effect. An illness that has arisen will not develop and is quickly pacified. The planets are thoroughly pacified. Wind, clouds, and lightning are halted with water. With a sprig of karavīra one performs all activities. Through this supremely accomplished heart of noble Avalokiteśvara, these activities are performed even without having first accomplished it.

Then, if one wishes to accomplish it, the procedure for the painted image is this. With every kind of color one should paint the image evenly, as that of a buddha: noble Avalokiteśvara should be shown wearing a crown of matted locks, with a deerskin wrapped around his lower body, wearing the attire of Paśupati, and adorned with all ornaments. The painter, keeping the poṣadha

vows, should draw the picture. Then the practitioner, in front of that image, should make a maṇḍala with cow dung, scatter white flowers, and set out eight vases filled with fragrant water. One should prepare the eight offerings, the sixty-four requisites, and a torma without blood but with meat. Burning agaru incense, one should recite the vidyā eight thousand times. Fasting for one day and night, or eating the three white foods, bathing three times a day and wearing clean clothes, one should do the recitation. Then one looks at oneself depicted in front of the image, and seeing this one becomes joyful. In due course noble Avalokiteśvara comes and fulfills all one's wishes. If one recites over realgar or eye ointment and anoints the eyes with it, one becomes invisible and travels through the sky. One attains the samādhi called the Assembly Wholly Free of Delusion. Whatever the practitioner wishes, he accomplishes through this. So it is said.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the bodhisattva great being noble Avalokiteśvara, those monks, those bodhisattvas, those sons of the gods of the Pure Abodes, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the Great Vehicle sūtra called the Heart of noble Amoghapāśa.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Amoghavajra and the Tibetan translator Bari Rinchen Drakpa.

Translator's Notes

• The name of the world system □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with confidence in Sanskrit, so it is translated by its meaning, "Beholding the World." The sentence □□□ is obscure, and the rendering given is tentative. "Ten hundred thousand samādhis" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, that is, a million. Several disease names, such as □□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□, are given approximate English equivalents. In "will generate his own roots of virtue," the Tibetan □□□□□□ could also be read as "my," Avalokiteśvara speaking of his own roots of virtue.
• "Without speaking aloud" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□. It may mean reciting silently, or reciting without speaking to anyone else. The list of "eight things" in the Tibetan contains more than eight items; it is translated as it stands. □□□□□□□□ is taken as Śaṅkara, an epithet of Śiva. In the Blessed One's reply, the subject of "will perform the role of a father" is unstated. It is taken as Avalokiteśvara, but it could be this heart-mantra.
• The speaker is the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, who addresses the Buddha at the close of the preceding piece. The dhāraṇī continues into the next piece.
• Several material and plant names are uncertain. "Dark butter" renders mar nag, whose exact referent (perhaps molasses or a dark oil) is unclear. "Rats" renders ba spu byi ba, which is obscure. The list of amulet plants (jayā, vijayā, and so on) gives the Sanskrit names where the Tibetan corresponds to known herb names. Abhayahastā and vimardanā are reconstructed from the Tibetan translations, and sunatta is kept as spelled. The words "evenly, as that of a

buddha" render a terse phrase whose exact sense is unclear. Paśupati, "Lord of Beasts," is an epithet of Śiva. "In due course" renders ji srid du ("until, as long as"), which here stands without its usual correlative; the sentence may be elliptical or corrupt.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.